

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

THE TATA CHRONICLE

When **Ratan Tata** wasn't battling Cyrus Mistry over control of the Tata empire, it turns out he was quietly meeting a former bureaucrat to pen his memoirs. *Ratan N. Tata: The Authorised Biography*, written by retired IAS officer Thomas Mathew, will be out this November. In the works for two years, the biography has the 84-year-old Chairman Emeritus of the Tata Group commenting on contentious issues—assuming charge in 1991, the politically-charged Singur agitation and his conflict with the Mistrys. The book triggered a six-month bidding war among publishers, which HarperCollins Publishers won recently with a Rs 2 crore offer.

Mamata Rules



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With Omicron spreading swiftly, West Bengal chief minister **Mamata Banerjee** is playing Didi to the hilt. The Trinamool Congress government is distributing pre-cooked food—brown rice, chicken, veggies and fruits—to all Covid-affected patients daily. Mamata, however, is not willing to halt the annual Gangasagar pilgrimage this month where tens of thousands people are due to descend. It's pilgrims' versus Covid's progress.

–Sandeep Unnithan with Romita Datta, Amarnath K. Menon, Ashish Misra, Kiran D. Tare

A BLAZING RAO

BJP president J.P. Nadda recently fired the opening salvo for the 2023 assembly election in Telangana. He accused the Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS) of dynastic rule and chief minister **K. Chandrashekar Rao** of corruption. A seething KCR and son **K.T. Rama Rao** have set up a team to track the implementation of all promises made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and BJP-ruled states since 2014. A Deccan retort is on its way.





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ACE OF MACE

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav has unhesitatingly flaunted his party's election symbol—the humble bicycle—in polls past. But the *aam aadmi* vehicle may just not stand up to the BJP's Ram temple juggernaut these elections. Hence, the rath-riding Yadav is brandishing a *gada* (mace) at his rallies. What better than to wield the weapon of choice of the greatest Rambhakt of all, Lord Hanuman, whose statue Yadav recently installed in his native Saifai.

Trunk Call

Elephants in the Kamalapur pachyderm park in Maharashtra's Gadchiroli district are all set to find a new home in Gujarat. The state forest department plans to relocate 13 of its 16 Indian elephants to the 250-acre Greens Zoological Rescue and Rehabilitation Kingdom in Jamnagar. The 50-year-old government-run park at Kamalapur has long been accused of mismanagement, a charge that gathered pace when three elephants died recently. Guess who's sponsoring the animal kingdom in Jamnagar? Reliance Industries—that's Jio for you.